

Part II: Identifying Your Product & Target Audience

Throughout the semester, you will design and build a website for your own original product or service idea using the skills you learn in this course. You are **NOT** creating a physical product in this course. Your focus is on building a product website that promotes, explains, or showcases your product or service idea.

Your idea can take one of the following forms:

- A service that your website presents and promotes.
- A simple web-based product or app built using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- A prototype of a more complex web or mobile app, with mockups or placeholder features (like login pages) that demonstrate the concept but don't require advanced backend development.

The goal is to apply web design and development skills to create a compelling, user-centered site around your idea—not to build the full product or app itself.

A. Define Your Product

Answer the following questions in your document:

1. What problem does your product website solve or address? **The problem that my website solves is not knowing what to eat with ingredients that you already have. It also reduces food waste and saving money**
2. What is your product idea? How does your website support this idea and help solve the problem? **My product idea is a web application that allow users to enter in ingredients they have in their kitchen and give meals based on that. This helps the user decide what to make with out spending more money and wasting food**
3. What type of website are you building? (i.e., e-commerce, brochure, portfolio, media, nonprofit, etc.) **I would be building a web app**
4. What is your mission statement? Summarize what your product does, who it's for, and why it matters. **My mission is to help people find easy and good meals based on ingredients they already have while saving money and reducing food waste**

B. Profile Of Target Audience

Answer the following questions in your document:

1. Who is the primary audience that your product is trying to reach? Include the following details about your target audience:

- Demographics

- What is the age range of your target audience?

18-45 years old

- What is the gender distribution?

All genders

- Which country do your visitors live in?

It could be anywhere to make it simple the United States

- Do they live in urban or rural areas?

It could be anywhere but Urban mainly since cities have an abundance of fast food restaurants

- Socioeconomic Details

- What is the average income of visitors?

15k - 75k

- What level of education do they have?

High school, College, anything higher

- What is their marital or family status?

Single people, couples, and families

- What is their occupation?

Working adult, Student

- How many hours do they work per week?

30-40+ hours per week

- Web Behavior

- How often do they use the web? **Daily**

- What kind of device do they use to access the web? **Phone, tablet, Laptop, Computer**

2. Create a chart with at least three fictional visitors from your target audience. This chart should include at least their name, sex, age, location, occupation, income and web use. You can create this chart manually or with AI tools like [ChatGPT](#).

Name	Sex	Age	Location	Occupation	Income	Web Use
Alex	Male	21	Boston, MA	College Student	\$18,000	Daily, mostly phone
Sarah	Female	29	Providence, RI	Office Worker	\$52,000	Daily, phone/laptop
Mike	Male	38	Chicago, IL	IT Specialist	\$70,000	Daily, phone/desktop

3. Create a list of reasons why people would be coming to your site and assign the list of tasks to the fictional visitors you created. You can complete this step manually or with AI tools like [ChatGPT](#).

Task	Visitor
Find a recipe using ingredients they already have	Alex
Save money by avoiding unnecessary grocery purchases	Alex
Find a quick meal after work	Sarah

Find recipes using leftover ingredients **Sarah**

Find highly rated recipes **Mike**

Get ideas for combining unusual ingredients **Mike**

Reduce food waste **All three**

Part III: Planning & Designing Your Product Website

Before you jump into building your site, it's essential to take a step back and plan with purpose. A beautiful website that doesn't meet its goals is a missed opportunity. Use this section to clarify your website's purpose, structure, and style so that your site is usable, accessible, and goal-driven.

A. Website Requirements

By addressing the questions below, you'll gain valuable insights into how to design a website that meets your goals and expectations.

1. Purpose & Goals

Answer the following questions in your document:

- What is the primary goal of your website (i.e., promote a service, sell a product, educate users, raise awareness, etc.)?
 - **My primary goal is to help users find recipes with ingredients they already have at home**
- What is the most important action you want users to take on your site (i.e., sign up, purchase, read articles, submit a form, etc.)?
 - **The most important action is for the user to enter ingredients and search for recipes**

2. Content & Features

Answer the following questions in your document:

- What content and features are essential to help users achieve their goals? List critical pages and features (i.e., About, Contact Form, Product Gallery, FAQs, Reviews, etc.).
 - **Home page, ingredient search, ingredient tab recipe result, recipe details, favorites, contact form/feedback**
- What will your homepage highlight? Think about the first impression and what visitors need to see right away.
 - **My homepage will have a have brief summary explaining what the web app is about and then it'll have a + button to add ingredients and there will results of the recipes showing high rated recommendations**

3. Look & Feel

Answer the following questions in your document:

- Do you have examples of websites that inspire your design? List 1–2 examples and what you like about them (i.e., layout, colors, interactivity, etc.). **I like [Tasty](#) due to its wide variety of recipes. Another I like is [Supercook](#) its similar to what I am making**
- How would you describe the overall style of your site (i.e., modern, bold, minimalist, playful, professional, etc.)? **Im going to make the style modern and simple so he user dont get overwhelmed.**
- Do you have preferences for color, fonts, or imagery? If not, what mood or personality do you want the site to convey? **I am probably going to use a light red or light violet as my main color and neutral colors alongside it**

B. Design & Prototyping

In this final section, you'll bring together your ideas and planning to shape the visual direction of your product website. You'll document your design choices and development strategy through diagrams, sketches, and visuals that guide your build process.

1. SDLC Approach & Timeline

In your answer document, outline how you plan to build your website using the SDLC. Your plan should include:

- The SDLC model you've chosen (Waterfall, Agile, Scrum, etc.).
- A clear timeline of phases and milestones.

- A visual representation of your timeline (e.g., Gantt chart, flowchart, or detailed bullet list).

You may create this manually or with AI tools ([ChatGPT](#), [Gantt Chart AI](#)).

Week	Phase	Tasks
Week 1	Planning	Finalize product idea, target audience, and website requirements
Week 2	Design	Create logo, sitemap, and wireframes
Week 3	Development	Build homepage and navigation
Week 4	Development	Build ingredient search and recipe results pages
Week 5	Testing	Test links, search features, layout, and usability
Week 6	Accessibility	Check accessibility and fix issues
Week 7	Finalization	Make final improvements and prepare the website for submission

2. Original Logo

Design a logo for your product website that visually captures your brand identity. Your logo must include:

- The name of your product.
- An image, icon, or design that represents your product.
- A transparent background (export as PNG).

Use free tools like [Pixlr X](#) to create your logo. You can check out a [video tutorial](#) or [written tutorial](#) on how to create a logo in Pixlr X.

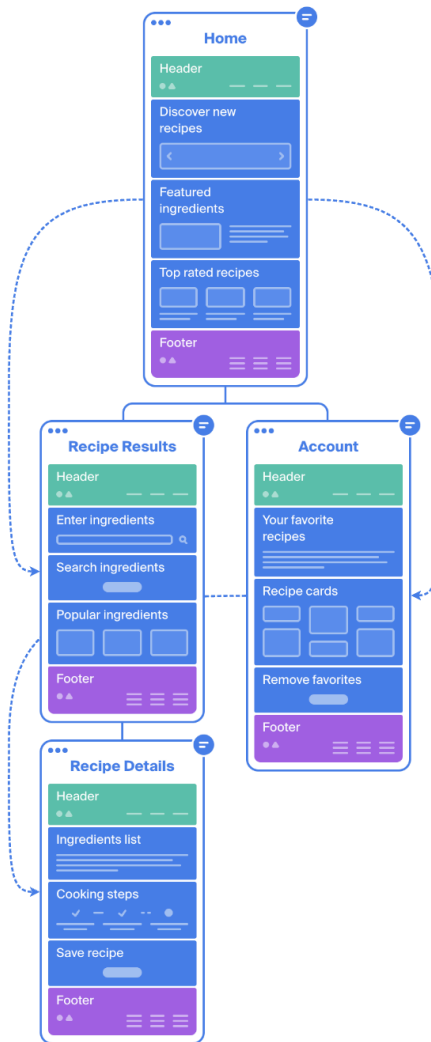


3. Site Map

Create a site map that shows how your site will be structured and how users will navigate between pages. Your site map should:

- Illustrate the structure and grouping of your web pages.
- Clearly shows how users will navigate between the pages.
- Reflect any feedback you received from your peers during the lab.

You can create your site map manually on paper, using draw.io or with AI tools



([Slickplan](https://Slickplan.com), Octopus.do).

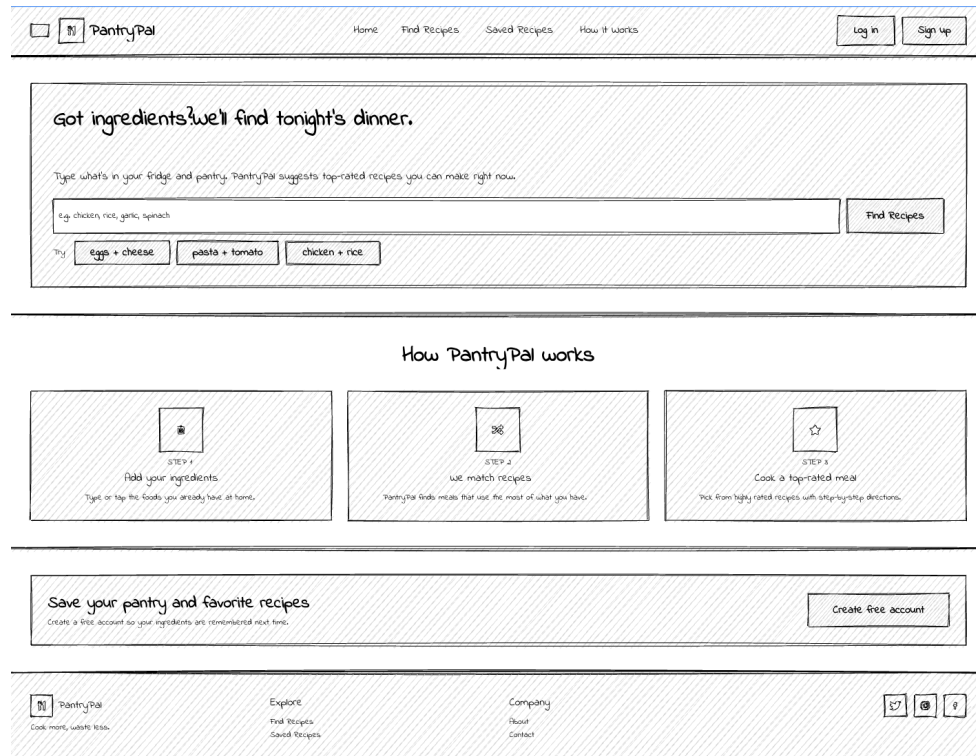
4. Wireframes

Design wireframes for your homepage and at least two other core pages. Your wireframes should:

- Clearly sketch where key information and interactive elements will be located. This must include placement of navigation bar and logo, and a layout of content across web pages.
- Focus on the homepage and at least two other pages.
- Reflect any feedback you received from your peers during the lab.

You can create your wireframes manually on paper, using draw.io or with AI tools ([Uizard](https://Uizard.io), [Figma with AI plugins](https://Figma.com)).

Home page



Recipe results

[Home](#)
[Find Recipes](#)
[Saved Recipes](#)
[How it works](#)
[Log in](#)
[Sign up](#)

[Back to results](#)

large recipe photo

Garlic Chicken & Rice

★★★★★ 4.9 (214 ratings)

[short recipe description - one or two sentences]

Time
35 min

Servings
4

Difficulty
EASY

You have 6 of 7 ingredients: Missing garlic

Save recipe

Ingredients

- ☐ 2 chicken breasts

have
- ☐ 1 cup rice

have
- ☐ 3 cloves garlic

add
- ☐ 1 onion, diced

have
- ☐ 1 cup sprouts

have
- ☐ 2 tbsp olive oil

have
- ☐ 1 cup cheddar

have

Instructions

- 1 Cook the rice
- 2 Season and sear the chicken
- 3 Sauté onion and garlic
- 4 Mix in the sprouts
- 5 Combine, top with cheese and serve

PantryPal
Cook more, waste less

[Explore Find Recipes](#)
[Saved Recipes](#)

[Company About](#)
[Contact](#)

Recipe detail

5. Accessibility

In your answer document, explain how your product website will be made accessible from the start. Your plan should include:

- Specific features you will implement to support users with visual, hearing, motor and cognitive impairments.
- Tools you will use to audit your site for accessibility.

You may create this manually or with AI tools ([ChatGPT](#), [WAVE](#), [Google Lighthouse](#)).

Visual Impairments

- Use good color contrast.
- Use readable font sizes.
- Make sure information is not communicated through color alone.

Hearing Impairments

- Any videos will include **captions**.
- Provide important information as text, not only through audio.

Motor Impairments

- Make buttons large enough to click easily.
- Make sure the website can be navigated using a keyboard.
- Avoid requiring precise mouse movements.

Cognitive Impairments

- Use simple and consistent navigation.
- Use clear headings and labels.
- Keep pages organized and avoid unnecessary information.
- Use clear instructions for entering ingredients and finding recipes.